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The Economic Shock

There is no subtler, no surer means of overturning the existing basis of society than to debauch the currency.

– John Maynard Keynes

For many years, I have been going to Sassoon Docks to buy fish. One gets the freshest and best variety of fish in Mumbai at this daily morning market that starts work at the crack of dawn.

There is a bustling eco-system in this crowded fish market. Koli fishermen throw baskets of fish up from their boats which are deftly caught by auctioneers on the quayside. Fish are auctioned by numbers not weight – the smaller fish in 11s or 22s while the bigger ones may even be sold solo. Each basket is auctioned within a few minutes. Wholesale fish vendors and bulk buyers from hotels and restaurants